

What did the European Union win in 2012?

1. The Walter Gropius Award for Architecture for the Brussels government district
2. The Right Livelihood Award for its climate protection laws
3. The Nobel Peace Prize

Answer: The European Union received the Nobel Peace Prize in 2012 because it has made a significant contribution over decades to securing peace, reconciliation, democracy, and stability in Europe. The prize was awarded to the EU as a whole because it has demonstrated that lasting peace is possible through cooperation, shared values, and the rule of law – even on a continent previously marked by war.

What do you think: Does the EU have an official anthem?

Answer: Yes, the "Ode to Joy" by Ludwig van Beethoven (4th movement of the 9th Symphony). Since 1985, it has been the official anthem, initially of the European Communities, later of the EU. It is used exclusively as an instrumental piece. There were various proposals to add lyrics (in Latin or in multiple languages), but none of these were adopted. Ultimately, lyrics were omitted to avoid favoring any single language and to respect cultural diversity.

Which of these points is not one of the fundamental freedoms in the internal market of the European Union according to Article 26 TFEU?

1. Free movement of goods
2. Freedom of expression
3. Freedom of movement of workers
4. Freedom of assembly
5. Freedom to provide services
6. Free movement of capital and payments

Answer: Freedom of expression and freedom of assembly are not among the fundamental freedoms of the EU's internal market, which are enshrined in Article 26 TFEU and are intended to reduce trade barriers. However, there is a legal basis for freedom of expression and freedom of assembly: the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union 😊.

Is the EU, as an institution, allowed to conclude treaties with other organizations and countries?

Answer: Yes, the EU has its own legal personality (Treaty of Lisbon).

Since the Treaty of Lisbon (2009), the EU can conclude international agreements, join organizations, and act as a single entity.

This strengthens its role in trade policy, climate protection, and international relations.

Which of these fundamental rights do EU citizens not enjoy?

1. Rights of older people
2. Right to good governance
3. Right to keep a pet
4. Right to access an employment service

Answer: There is no right to keep a pet, but all other rights are! All fundamental rights are enshrined in the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union and became legally binding with the Treaty of Lisbon. It guarantees, among other things, data protection, equality, freedom of expression, and workers' rights.

What do you think: How many official languages are there in the European Union?

Answer: The European Union has 24 official languages. According to Article 24 TFEU, all EU citizens have the right to address the EU institutions in any of the 24 languages listed in Article 55 TEU and to receive a reply in the same language.

Do you know of an EU country that was ruled by a dictatorship until the 1970s and has been a member of the EU since the 1980s?

Answer: *There are actually three! Greece was the first to join in 1981, making the EU membership a double-digit number. Spain and Portugal followed five years later.*

The European flag flies over parliaments, buildings, parks, and monuments throughout Europe.

What do the 12 gold stars on a blue background represent?

Answer: *The 12 gold stars on the blue background of the European flag symbolize the ideals of unity, solidarity, and harmony among the peoples of Europe. The number 12 does not represent the number of member states, but rather symbolizes perfection and completeness.*

Which country is it?

- It fought a war of independence between 1991 and 1995
- It has a coat of arms with a red and white checkerboard pattern
- It is the most recent country to join the European Union

Answer: Croatia! It is the newest member of the EU, having joined in 2013.

At what age are you allowed to vote in elections to the European Parliament?

Answer: In most EU countries, the voting age is 18. In Austria, Belgium, Germany, and Malta, the voting age is 16, while in Greece, you can vote at 17.